



Ultimate Converged Accessories



Illustration Binesh Shreedharan

The stuff dreams are made of... for geeks anyway! Presenting the best of the converged devices available today. A word of caution: Highly obsessive!

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After a decade of blank and weightless proclamations, the age of digital convergence has finally dawned upon us. With industry bigwigs including Intel, AMD, Sony and Microsoft, to name a few shifting to solution-centric strategies, digitally converged products are making it to the mass markets—slowly, but steadily.

Digital convergence is bringing three major industries together—the IT industry with its hardware and software expertise, the consumer electronics industry—deeply rooted into entertainment and the telecommunication industry that enables short to long range communications.

Such a diverse communion results in the manufacture of extremely versatile products that combine the best of technologies from all three sectors. Just a few years ago, cell phones that doubled as digital camera, audio/video players or gaming consoles that transformed into a media-centric device were unthinkable. But now, they seem to be the imminent future.

Rapid developments in technology leading to faster chips, higher bandwidth buses and broadband communication are proving to be the major driving factors behind the convergence trend; not to

mention the warm-hearted acceptance from consumers who are always on the lookout for that something new.

In this article, we bring to you some of the coolest products that incorporate cutting-edge technology and convey the very essence of digital convergence in their own unique way.

Oakley Thump

Oakley's Thump is the coolest converged product that combines fashion with technology in a unique way of its own. While audio players have been built into watches, headphones and cell phones, Thump is the first audio player to be built into sunglasses.

The Thump is made out of lightweight durable plastic and is hence suitable for use all day long. The lenses can be flipped up, making it possible for the shades to be used indoors without skipping on listening to your favourite music.

The earphones are well-placed and highly adjustable. They can be rotated, extended or raised to fit any ears without much discomfort. The controls are placed on the two arms of the shade.

Buttons on the left side are for volume control while those on the right are for Play/Pause/Power and Skip/Shuffle. Songs are played back either in the order they are copied or alphabetically. There